

One answer is: Yes.

Physical properties can
cause phenomenal
properties, **and**

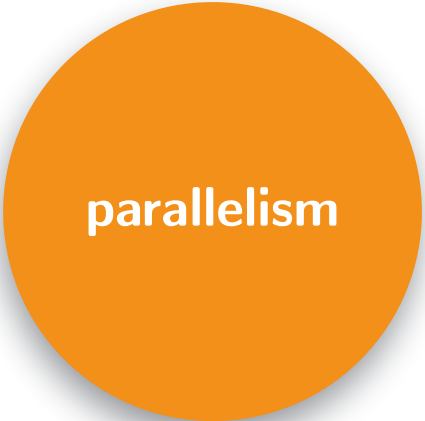
phenomenal properties can
cause physical properties.

A second answer is: Yes.

Physical properties can
cause phenomenal
properties; **but** phenomenal
properties cannot cause
physical properties.



interactionism

A large, solid orange circle is centered on a white background. The word "parallelism" is written in white, lowercase, sans-serif font across the middle of the circle.

parallelism



**epi-
phenomenalism**

ANN'S BLOOD SUGAR
FALLS BELOW 80
MG/DL

ANN FEELS HUNGER,
AND DECIDES TO
WALK TO THE
FRIDGE.

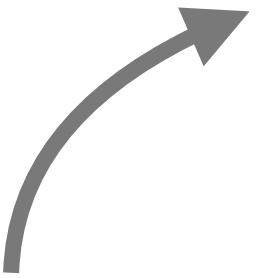
ANN WALKS TO THE
FRIDGE AND OPENS
THE DOOR

ANN HAS A VISUAL
SENSATION OF AN
APPLE AND DECIDES TO
EAT IT.

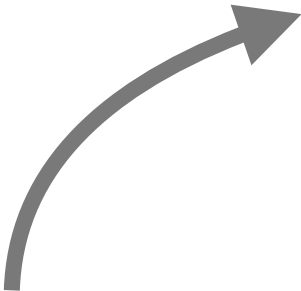
ANN REACHES OUT FOR THE
APPLE AND BRINGS IT TO
HER MOUTH AND TAKES A
BITE.

ANN TASTES THE APPLE
AND FEELS LESS
HUNGRY .











This might push one towards the initially surprising epiphenomenalist position. Unlike the parallelist, the epiphenomenalist does not think of the physical and mental realms as entirely disconnected. And unlike the interactionist, the epiphenomenalist does not have to think that physics must be supplemented with an additional mental 'force.'









But peripheralism leads to a puzzle.

Suppose that I ask you how you are feeling, and you say 'I am feeling cold.' The event of you saying that is a physical event. It is a report of one of your phenomenal properties. Since (according to the epiphenomenalist) phenomenal properties never cause physical events, your utterance of 'I am cold' was not caused (even indirectly) by your feeling cold.

The conceivability argument, in its different forms, is a powerful challenge to the idea that consciousness can be smoothly assimilated into a worldview which holds that everything is, ultimately, physical.

But if one rejects that worldview, and holds that phenomenal properties are not physical properties, one faces the question of how the physical and phenomenal are related. And our discussion so far shows that this is a tough question to answer.

One answer is: Yes.

causaphenomenal

causal/physical properties.

phenomenal properties can

properties, and

Physical properties can

physical properties.

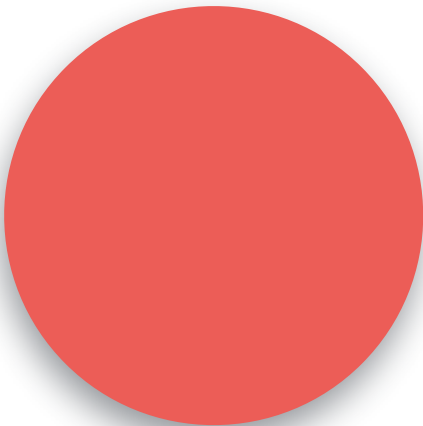
properties; but phenomena

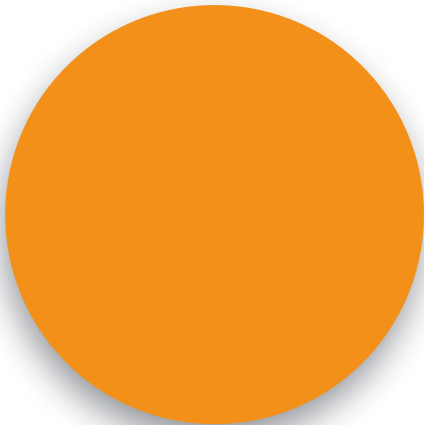
Physical properties can

A second answer is: Yes.

causal phenomena

properties cannot cause



















This might push one towards the initially surprising phenomenon

the physical and mental realms as entirely disconnected. And unlike

position. Unlike the parallelist, the peripheralist does not think of



physicist be supplemented with an additional mental 'force.'

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We've now covered the main arguments for the view

that you are, either entirely or in part, an immaterial

thing.



against that view.

We have already encountered two kinds of arguments

seem to be more of a problem for the simpler believer in

souls.



immaterial stuff that the fusion bubble is in

The first are the “easy arguments” for materialism. These

countered with the knowledge arguing that the

shouldn't believe in fairies: there

is no good evidence for their existence. That might be

conceivability argument.

There second is the argument that we should not believe in